

Agile Project Management

CHAPTER 3: AGILE PLANNING

Chapter Objectives

In this chapter, we will:

- Look at the concept of “sprint zero”
- Discuss the decisions that need to be made at the start of the effort
- Address the issue of self organizing teams and management

Sprint Zero

- Before the actual development begins
- May be shorter than the iteration size
- Typical activities
 - Determine the physical layout
 - What tools are needed?
 - What access is needed?
 - Is there any software needed beforehand?
 - Get organized
- May be an elongated product/project planning meeting

Iteration Planning

- ◆ Iteration planning describes, at a fine level of granularity, what will happen in the iteration*
 - Allocates activities to roles and allocates individuals to roles
- ◆ At the beginning of each successive phase, the iteration plan is revisited and revised as necessary
 - Add iterations
 - Change iteration goals
 - Remove or combine iterations

*Krutchen, *The Rational Unified Process: An Introduction*, Addison-Wesley, 2005, p. 134

Discussion: Iteration Length



- What is a good iteration length? Should an iteration last two weeks or four? What are the conditions that help define the length of an iteration?
- In the table on the next slide, identify the positive aspects of short and long iterations
- Be prepared to discuss your suggestions
- The instructor will compile a complete list of reasons for longer and shorter iterations

Discussion: Iteration Length (continued)



Shorter Iterations	Longer Iterations

Exercise 3.1: Define the Size of the Sprint



- For your project, what is going to be the size of your sprint?
- Remember that it will be the same size for the remainder of the project
- Considerations
 - Ability of resources to perform
 - Ability of business to review and have meetings
 - Expected size and complexity of work to be done
 - Overall project deadline

What About Architecture?

- Architecture is usually defined before starting Scrum
- May be part of sprint zero
- Changes are made to existing system or architecture
- May use architecture spikes

Exercise 3.2: Define Done



- Create a definition of “done” to the team
- Needs input from the business
 - What will the product owner expect at delivery?
 - What is the level of quality expected?
- How are you going to guarantee that the product or increment is “done”?

Project/Product Planning Meeting

- One time only at beginning of project
- Lay out the entire project with products
- Discuss release plan
- Developers get an understanding of the entire product backlog
- Organize and develop team
- Sometimes part of sprint zero

Exercise 3.3: Product Planning Meeting



- Conduct a product planning meeting
 - Define the overall product to be built by end of project
 - Define the basic problem
 - Establish the goal and the vision
 - Define any deadlines required for the product
 - Elaborate on the product backlog items as necessary
 - At least those at the top of the backlog
 - Add any new tasks necessary
 - Especially those required by the development team
 - Re-sequence where necessary for technological reasons
 - Complete the product backlog in preparation for the development team
- } Initial thoughts and ideas

Chapter Summary

In this chapter, we have:

- Looked at the concept of “sprint zero”
- Discussed the decisions that need to be made at the start of the effort
- Addressed the issue of self organizing teams and management